

PEN & PAPER June 8th, 2026

— PROBLEM SOLVING —



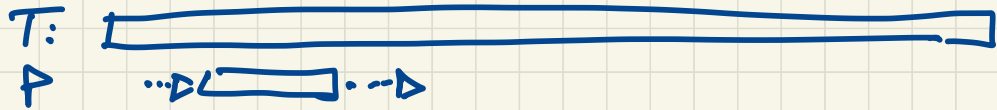
PATTERN MATCHING

THE PROBLEM

Input: text T of length n , pattern P of length m

Output: occurrences of P in T

"BRUTE-FORCE" METHOD



$O(n \cdot m)$ comparisons : can we do better ?!

.... C A G A C A G T A G A

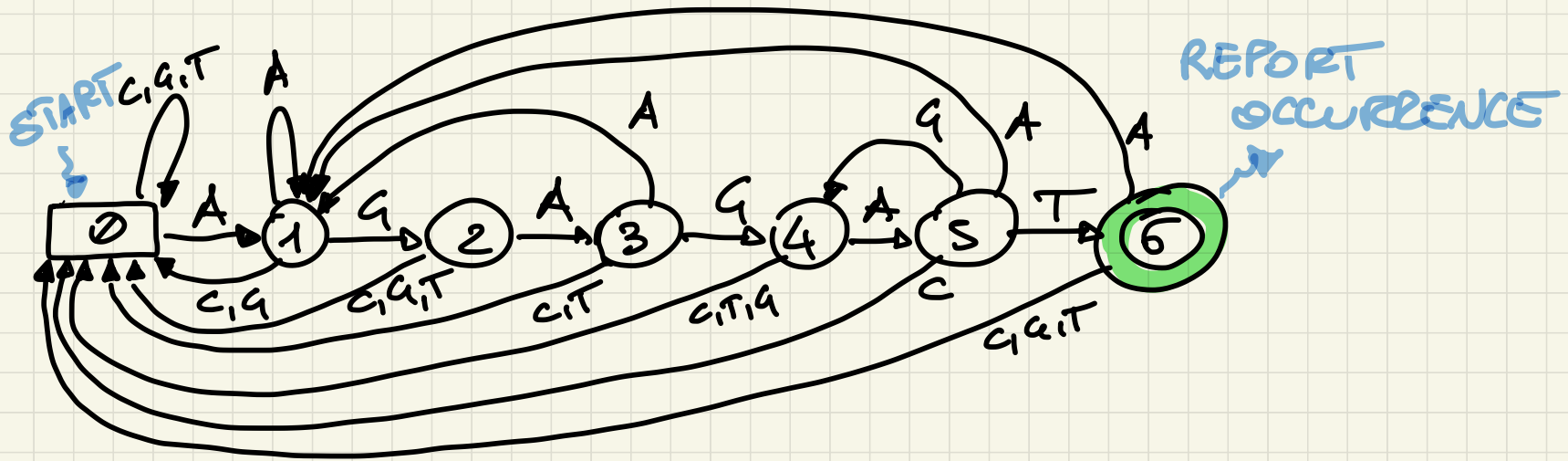
~~A~~
→ A G A G A T ..
→ A G A G A

→ A G A

Text

Pattern AGAGAT

AUTOMATA



IT'S YOUR TURN!

$$P_1 = CAT$$

$$P_2 = CTQ$$

BUILD THE
AUTOMATA!

$$P = A^* \{ C \} T \{ A \} C$$

BUILD THE AUTOMATA!

DE BRUIJN GRAPHS

k-dBG

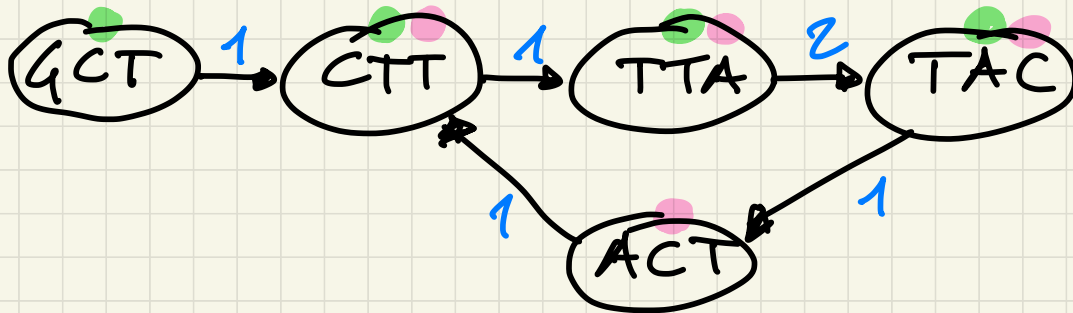
$\Sigma = \{A, C, G, T\}$

given k

and given a set S of sequences

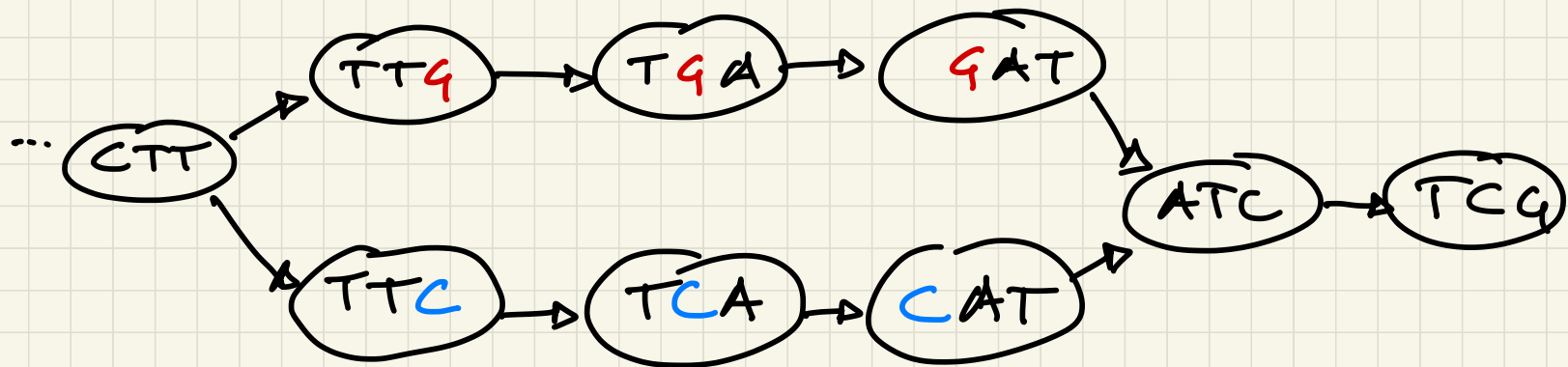
- A node $\forall$ $k\text{-mer} \in S$
- Edge $x \rightarrow y$ iff x and y overlap by $k-1$ letters and $\frac{x}{y} \in S$

$S = \{GCTTAC, TTACTT\}$



SNPs in DBG :

S : ... CTT **G** ATC ... (S₁)
... CTT **C** ATC ... (S₂)



TWO ALTERNATIVE PATHS OF k NODES
FROM A COMMON SOURCE TO A COMMON TARGET

IT'S YOUR TURN!

WHAT IF I HAVE
AN INDEL?

S : ... TTC ^{length l} TTGAA CQT .. (S_1)
... TTC CQT (S_2)

$x=3$

WHAT IF I HAVE
A FRAGMENT
SUBSTITUTION?

(e.g. AS in mRNA)

S_1 ... CAT F_1 TCQ ...
 S_2 ... CAT F_2 TCQ ...

$|F_1| = l_1$ $|F_2| = l_2$

EFFICIENT ALGORITHMS ON ARRAYS

"PSEUDOCODE" OF BINARY SEARCH (iterative version)

$BS(A, p, r, k) // BS(A, 0, n-1, k)$

IF $((k < A[p]) \vee (k > A[p]))$

THEN RETURN -1;

WHILE $(p < r)$ DO

$\{ q = \frac{p+r}{2};$

IF $(A[q] == k)$ THEN RETURN q ;

IF $(A[q] > k)$ THEN $r = q - 1$

ELSE $p = q + 1$

RETURN -1

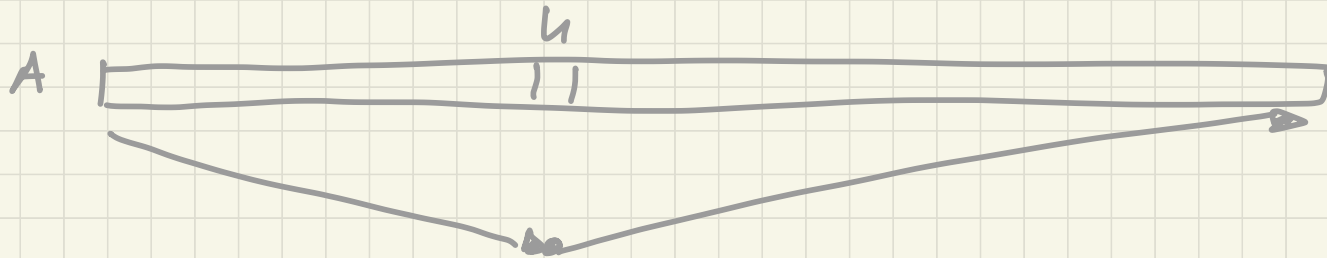
Input: SORTED A ; VALUE k

Output: $i: A[i] = k$
-1 if $k \notin A$

IT'S YOUR TURN !

Input: A array : $\exists 0 \leq h \leq n-1$ such that
 $A[0] > \dots > A[h] < A[h+1] < \dots < A[n-1]$

Output: h



WRITE AN EFFICIENT PSEUDOCODE !

12 COINS

YOU HAVE 12 APPARENTLY IDENTICAL COINS
BUT AT MOST ONE OF THEM IS ACTUALLY "SPECIAL,
AND HENCE LIGHTER OR HEAVIER

YOU HAVE A TWO PLATES SCALE
($\Rightarrow$ 3 POSSIBLE OUTCOMES

— — —)



DESIGN A PROCEDURE TO FIND THE
SPECIAL COIN (IF THERE) USING THE
SCALE AT MOST 3 TIMES

SEQUENCE ALIGNMENT

Input: X, Y sequences

Output: the best alignment of X and Y

E.G. MINIMUM EDIT DISTANCE

OR

MAXIMUM SIMILARITY SCORE

THERE IS AN EXPONENTIAL NUMBER
OF POSSIBLE ALIGNMENTS!

Check ANTOINE'S CLASS TOMORROW!